Social Media: Alt Text

Abi Harrison-Nye

What is it for?

On social media, images often hold the core message or punchline. Alt text ensures that context isn't lost for anyone by serving a few vital purposes:

- Allows screen readers to describe the visual content to visually impaired users
- Displays text descriptions when poor signal or low data prevents images from loading
- Helps users with cognitive disabilities better understand complex graphics or memes
- Boosts discoverability by helping platform algorithms understand and index your posts

How to support it

In workplace chat tools like Slack, upload the image, click ‘Edit file details’, and fill in the description.

In PowerPoint, right-click the image, then ‘View Alt Text’. In Google Slides, use ‘Format options’, then ‘Alt text’.

On LinkedIn, add the image and click ‘ALT’ at the bottom right.

On Facebook, add the image, open its menu (the button with three dots), and select ‘Edit alt text’.

On X (Twitter), add the image and click the ‘ALT’ box at the bottom.

Useful Links

Alternative text on social media

Alternative text in action

Social Media and Alternative Text: A Reflection